The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Ocean of Dharma"

Āryadharmasāgaranāmadhāraṇī · Toh 975 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཆོས་ཀྱི་རྒྱ་མཚོ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Ocean of Dharma," known in Sanskrit as Ārya Dharmasāgara Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Chökyi Gyatso Zhejawé Zung, is a short dhāraṇī scripture presented as the words of the Buddha himself. It opens in Vārāṇasī, in the Deer Park at Ṛṣivadana, where the Buddha is staying with an assembly of five hundred monks, the same setting as his first teaching. There he tells the monks that he has realized a Dharma that is profound, subtle, and hard to see, to be understood by the wise, and that he offers it out of compassion for the benefit and happiness of gods and humans. The text then frames this teaching in the form of a dhāraṇī, a sacred formula whose recitation is meant to preserve and convey the Dharma's power. It is Toh 975 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the many dhāraṇī texts gathered in the tantra section of the canon.

In the language of India: ārya dharma sāgara nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Ocean of Dharma."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying in Vārāṇasī, at Ṛṣivadana in the Deer Park, together with a great saṅgha of monks, a full five hundred monks. Then the Blessed One addressed the monks, and the monks listened to the Blessed One. The Blessed One spoke these words:

"Monks, I have realized a Dharma that is profound, hard to see, hard to realize, and subtle, to be known by the wise who examine and understand. For the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of compassion for the world, for the welfare of the great multitude, and for the benefit and happiness of gods and humans, I have turned the wheel of Dharma. So that I may turn the unobstructed wheel of Dharma, I shall accomplish it with certainty alone.

"Monks, there is a Dharma discourse called the Dhāraṇī of the Ocean of Dharma, taught and explained by the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas, who possess a mind of mindfulness, a mind of intelligence, a mind of realization, a steadfast mind, and a mind of wisdom, who possess supreme speech and supreme eloquence, and who know and see. Those who know it

and those who hold it will very swiftly obtain five things. What are the five? They are these: they will come to possess mindfulness that retains what they have heard; they will come to possess mindfulness free of forgetfulness, and an intelligence by which the teachings they hold are never lost; they will come to possess realization that has attained keenness; they will come to possess unobstructed eloquence that enters into letters, meanings and words; and, having directly known the causal path of sentient beings, they will become skilled in recollecting former lives. These five things were established by the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas of the past, and now I too establish them."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, I shall teach you the summary of the foundations of the synopsis of all dharmas. Through it, you will hear teachings you have not heard. You will retain the teachings you have heard. You will put into practice the teachings you have retained. And you will bring others to understand the teachings you have practiced.

"The five divisions of words are these: the division of the words of formations; likewise, the division of the words of unheard teachings; the division of unsurpassed words; the division of the words of letters examined from stage to stage; and the division of the words of etymological explanation and of various conventional terms.

"Among these, these are words that make splendor steadfast, endowed with vidyā-mantra: all the yakṣas, rākṣasas, kumbhāṇḍas, pretas and piśācas of the world-system of four continents who have come to Jambudvīpa will give that person all kinds of food and medicines.

"Among these, these are the words of secret mantra that have arisen from the Dharma, that do no harm to others, that were spoken by the Tathāgata, that have been accepted by gods, nāgas, yakṣas and gandharvas, and that uphold the teaching. Ānanda, listen to these words of secret mantra, lest you regret it later:

syād ya the da na karma ke ta ma nucche ra ti ru ta gra na dra ma thu ma na nai la ta a saṃ ku la sthā bu mi a nusma ri i śaṃ ga ma i śa stā kle na a nu ga te yā mu la gum bhe pa bhe ma gu rba ya ba a sya bā kya sya bi laṃ ga be la ma tha śrī ba ba rī bañca ka bra sa te a ba be la a gra be la ni śi khu u ce ju me u je ju me

"Ānanda, these are the accomplished invocation of the yakṣas, and the binding of those yakṣas who, on seeing the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly

awakened Buddha Kāśyapa, both honored him and served him. Ānanda, you must hold these accomplished invocations of the yakṣas spoken by the Tathāgata.

"Ānanda, whoever holds, bears and masters these flawless words of secret mantra, the Four Great Kings will abide with that person according to his wish. Ānanda, by holding these words of secret mantra one will come to possess mindfulness, and one will never be separated from the buddhas.

"Ānanda, in the eastern continent of Videha dwells a yakṣa called Illuminator of Existence. Ānanda, in the western continent of Godānīya dwells a yakṣa called Great Enjoyer. Ānanda, in the northern continent of Kuru dwells a yakṣa called Widely Renowned. Ānanda, in Jambudvīpa dwells a yakṣa called Attainer of Fame. Ānanda, those yakṣas too will keep that person in mind.

"Ānanda, whatever other yakṣas there are who devour vital splendor, they too will gain faith. And having gained faith, they will set out in order to attain unshakable faith.

"Ānanda, among these, these are the words of vigilance taught by the sage. Ānanda, hold the words of the Tathāgata, the supreme sage, the supreme of words, the words that bring no harm to any living creature or bhūta, and I shall speak them. Ānanda, in this regard, even the yakṣas who follow after me will be unable to create obstacles."

syādyathedana dan dharamahāhara haramaparana ruddratra kumatidritra indramanduke abate saharā sadhumati ilalapamati abati tarabara yibiṣṭasadabiṣṭa abatiṣṭa paribarta iśabarta sadabarta kramakramatirana asibacemalabinahathi braśasure dhudhu ukkamukgra ukgrabati bisaragramati

"All the yakṣas, bhūtas, kumbhāṇḍas, pretas, pūtanas, nāgas, gandharvas and piśācas dwelling throughout the whole great world system of four continents, whoever they may be, those who dwell within houses and those who have set out on the road, will rejoice on hearing these words spoken by the Tathāgata. Ānanda, hold these words of the dhāraṇī-mantra, lest you regret it later."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"These accomplished yakṣas
Are called the chiefs in the four continents.
Whoever holds these secret mantras,
His mindfulness will increase.
Those yakṣas of whom the buddhas spoke,

Having come to him,
Will show him the teachings of the Dharma kings
That have fallen into decline.

Even across many hundreds of yojanas,
Having gone there step by step,
These profound and meaningful words
Should be listened to.
These are the root of all dharmas;
Let the wise listen to them.
Even if the fierce should hear them,
Afterward they will be supremely joyful.
One in whom there is neither pleasure nor pain,
For him this will become joy.

This ground is free from attachment;
The ground of the buddhas is inconceivable.
Having attained that inconceivable ground
Taught as free from attachment,
Like the sun emerging from the clouds,
So he shines upon the earth.
Herein the sense sources and the aggregates,
The truths, the limbs of awakening, the faculties,
The profound virtuous dharmas,
Whatever the buddhas have taught, is present.
Whatever stores of learning he has
Will never go to waste.
He will hear dharmas he has not heard before,
And be skilled in what is faulty and what is not.
Supreme in realization and understanding,
Even fine eyes will become purified.
One who holds this and teaches it
The buddhas always praise.

In the dharmas of the buddhas
There is no doubt. By whatever truth there is,
By that truth, may all the scripture I have received,
Whatever there is, remain firm.
By the truth that the buddhas

Abide in loving-kindness toward beings,
In my own mind and in the minds of others
May the Teacher be firmly established.

The yakṣas who dwell in the four continents
Teach the faithless to have faith.
To one who is not granted realization
They will show the meaning of it all.
Whoever is the yakṣa Star Face,
And Elephant Trunk, and Special Strength,
Fierce One, Joy Maker, and Killer,
Moon, Headless, and Sheep Killer,
Heroic Host and Heroic Hand,
Rākṣasa and Earth Holder,
Green Mouth and Fine Ear,
Sword Hair and Ass:
May they all bring accomplishment!

Whoever holds these secret mantras,
Those yakṣas and rākṣasas,
Becoming delighted, will lead him in.
He will always become skilled in eloquence,
In words and in explanations,
In etymologies and in all dharmas,
And in the letters.
The scripture he has received will not go to waste,
And boundless realization will increase.
Always, in meaning and in letter,
His knowledge will increase.
The gods of the Thirty-Three
And Brahmā, lord of the Sahā world,
Those who listen to his eloquent words,
Will at once keep him in mind."

syādyathedana hukuna mukuna haraṇa biñaraṇa iśasaṃkramaṇa oṃsumukha tagaṇa agaṇa apriya usthāme kobahare urupa prabaṇatana saṃgramebahajagare braśigare guḍhabane uttana bikuṇa iśakuna atulatula aṭibaṭi baricamośa hara jagata ebasaṃpramukhe agabare ṭhahusahu itiya thāhu caturadvībikāyan ṭhahumahu ukgahu dhārasahu saṃgraha a'inagraha

abinagraha brajñābridbhaye thahusahu karakuru dhasahu

Concerning this it is said:

"Whoever has these words of secret mantra
Upon his hand and body
Will not be confused in what he hears;
He will not become devoid of wisdom.
Like a shooting star, like the sun,
Like the shining of the moon,
So, through learning and through meaning,
He will reach all the way to nirvāṇa."

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these secret mantras:

syādyathedan caradhebicaradhe amaṃkute atimiti parahare ghaṇabhe hiparame mahāpratipāhāne jayajaya anuke balabale ukgrabati svarasvara abisare gugunde prabibardhe same ajitajaye nubalesukhomasusandhinikuṃmano sakṣe śāpecāpe cāpecāpe cubecube culuculu pulupulu byabaprasare karakabhindhe bijābije apratisandhi nānānumati prananumati aridasi jeṣṣānupanide asaṃgra abati

If one wears these words of secret mantra, the compendium of vidyā-mantras, carrying them upon the body, then all the yakṣas, rākṣasas, kumbhāṇḍas, pretas and piśācas dwelling in the great world system of four continents will come under one's power, and even those not yet under one's power will come under it. All one's aims, too, will be just as the Tathāgata has granted, and until the very end of one's life one will not die and will not come to ruin.

The rite for this is as follows. Staying in a solitary place, one should recite all these dhāraṇī-mantras for seven days, keeping them in mind three times by day and three times by night. Then, once seven days have passed, all one's intentions will be fulfilled.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Ānanda, that entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Ocean of Dharma."

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptors Surendrabodhi and Prajñāvarma, the chief editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, and others.

Translator's Notes

• The names of the four yakṣas of the four continents could not be identified with confidence, so their meanings are translated: Illuminator of Existence, Great Enjoyer, Widely Renowned, Attainer of Fame. The phrase rendered "according to his wish" might also be read as "as his own mind," that is, intimately present with him. Kuru stands for the northern continent, Uttarakuru. The final sentence may also be read as "whichever yakṣas are my followers cannot create obstacles."
• The yakṣa names in the list beginning "Star Face" could not be identified with confidence as standard Sanskrit names, so they have been translated by meaning. "Rākṣasa" in that list may be a generic term rather than a personal name. The phrase rendered "lest you regret it later" is colloquial and somewhat uncertain. In the verse list of what the Dharma contains, the word rendered "faculties" is taken as indriya, not empowerment.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.